Level 1 review and the path of a piece

Level 2 · Lesson 1 · staff, note values and time signature · the upbeat and repeats with “Alla Turca”

Teacher’s guide. © 2026 Music Motion.

For: ages 9 to 14, the whole class. **Length:** 50 minutes. It is the way into Level 2, also for those who did not do Level 1.

Main objective: by the end of the lesson, while listening to Mozart’s “Alla Turca” with the score projected, pupils point out the upbeat, the repeat bars, the double bars and the Coda, and say how many times each part is played.

Secondary objectives: (1) read a Level 1 melody (“Ode to Joy”) with rhythm syllables and note names; (2) write down, with note values, a four-beat rhythm they hear.

What you need: a computer with speakers and internet, the board and, if possible, a projector. It helps to have done Level 1. **No music knowledge needed:** the score lights up as it plays.

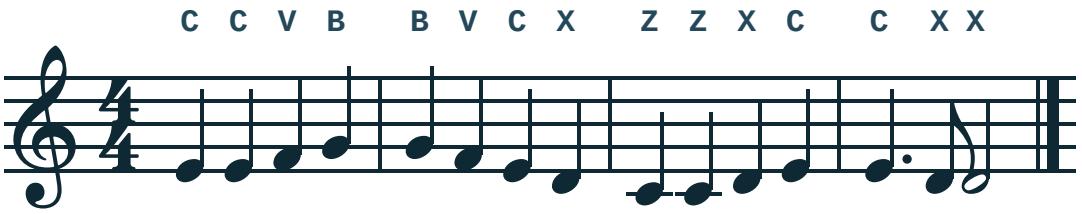
Before the lesson (15 minutes, at home): practise.

- Open “Alla Turca” in the Score and listen to the whole piece following the score. Find the first note, before the first bar line: that is the upbeat. In bar 8 you will see the two dots and the thick bar line of the repeat. Remember ⛶ **FULL**, **−** / **+** and the **PULSE** knob (with it the word “Allegretto” changes; “Coda” does not, because it is not a tempo word).
- Also open “Ode to Joy” for the review, and the Cosmic Keyboard with the metronome (**pulse**, about 60 BPM with **tap**, **start** and **click**, as in Level 1) for the dictation.
- Look at the pupil’s sheet at the end.

Before we start: what they already know and the path of a piece

The essentials of Level 1, on one page

The staff: five lines counted from the bottom up; notes live on the lines or in the spaces. **The treble clef** curls around line 2, which is called G. **Note values** are pieces of a chocolate bar: semibreve (whole note) 4 beats, minim (half note) 2, crotchet (quarter note) 1, two quavers (eighth notes) in 1, and each note value has its rest. **The time signature**: the top number says how many beats; the bottom one, which note value is the beat (4 = crotchet); C = 4/4. **The tempo** is a number of beats per minute and an Italian word.



"Ode to Joy" (Beethoven): all of Level 1 in four bars.

The time machine: the Classical period

In Level 2 each lesson visits a period in the history of music through a piece that is heard with its score. We begin in Vienna, around 1783: Mozart writes a piano sonata whose last movement imitates the Turkish military bands —the Janissaries, with cymbals and drums— that were in fashion. It is **Classical** music: phrases that ask and answer, a melody in the right hand with its accompaniment in the left, and a clear form in which **a refrain returns** (it is called a rondo).

> **The road signs:** in "Alla Turca" we find the **upbeat** (the piece starts before the first complete bar), the **repeat bars** (each part is played twice), the **double bars** (a section ends), the **Coda** ("tail": the special ending) and, at the very end, a **ritardando**. They are all on the pupil's sheet.

The lesson, step by step

The lesson follows five stages: the goal, what they already know, the new material, the application and the review of the goal. **In each activity, you do it first and the class follows you.**

1 The goal

3 min

Tell the class, in these words or similar ones:

“In Level 1 we learned to read and write music. Today we review, and then we will follow a piece by Mozart with our eyes: a score is not always read straight through, it has signs that tell us which way to go.”

Write the goal on the board: **I can follow the path of a piece in the score.**

2 What they already know: reading and writing

12 min

Reading (6 min). Project “Ode to Joy”. You find the clef and the time signature; then the class reads the rhythm with syllables and, finally, the note names. Press ▶ to check.

Dictation (6 min). Play on `Z` a four-beat rhythm (crotchets, quavers, a minim, a rest). Write it on the board yourself first while saying it with syllables. Then you play another one and the pupils write it on their sheet; they correct it together. Two rounds.

3 New material: the road signs

13 min

1. **Vienna, 1783** (3 min). Tell in two sentences where “Alla Turca” comes from (see “Before we start”). Project the score with ⛶ FULL.
2. **The upbeat** (4 min). Show the first note, before the first bar line. “How many beats are in the bar? 2. How long does this note last? One. The piece starts on two: that is why we say it arrives early.” The class marches in 2 (as in Level 1) and listens to the beginning: the first step falls on bar 1, not on the upbeat.
3. **Repeating and ending** (6 min). Show the repeat bar in bar 8: “the two dots say: go back and play it again.” Then look together for the double bars, the word Coda and the rit. at the end. Write them on the board with their meaning.

With an interactive whiteboard or a projector, the class sees the score on the screen; without a screen, draw the signs on the board and let the piece play.

4 Application: following the path

17 min

Show it yourself first with the first 8 bars: press ▶ and point with your finger as it plays; when you reach the repeat bar say “again!” and go back.

1. Hand out the roles: one group raises a hand at each repeat bar, another at each double bar, another when the Coda appears.
2. Press ▶ and let the whole piece play (about 3 minutes; with the PULSE knob you can make it slower). Each group gives its signal.
3. Afterwards, the whole class rebuilds the path on the board: how many parts, which ones repeat, where the Coda begins.
4. With the cymbal march (the part in A major, with strong chords in the left hand): “How many times does it come back?” That returning refrain is what makes the piece a rondo.

5 Reviewing the goal

5 min

Go back to the sentence on the board.

“What is an upbeat? What do the two dots on a bar line say? Why is the ending called the Coda?”

Listen to the answers and finish with the question about the period: “What is it about this music that makes it sound like a march?” (the time signature in 2, the chords that imitate drums and cymbals).

Challenge for the quick ones: “If each of the parts in the first 24 bars is played twice, how many bars are actually heard?” The first two parts are 8 and 16 bars long: (8 + 16) × 2 = **48**. Scores save paper with repeats.

If they find it hard:

- **They don’t see the upbeat:** count the bars from the first bar line; the note before it is “outside the house”, like someone who arrives before the door opens.
- **They get lost at the repeats:** slow the piece down with the knob and point with your finger on the screen; say “again” out loud at each repeat.
- **They confuse a double bar with a final bar:** the final one has a thick line; the double one, two thin lines.
- **The dictation is hard for them:** have them say it with syllables and clap it first, and then write it.

The keys and their notes

QWERTY

Top · high notes

Q	W	E	R	T	Y	U
C	D	E	F	G	A	B

Middle

A	S	D	F	G	H	J
C	D	E	F	G	A	B

Bottom · low notes

Z	X	C	V	B	N	M
C	D	E	F	G	A	B

For the dictation one key is enough, `Z`; “Ode to Joy” is played on the bottom row.

Note names: *C = Do · D = Re · E = Mi · F = Fa · G = Sol · A = La · B = Si. Some materials use the syllables: both name the same note.*

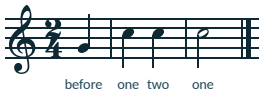
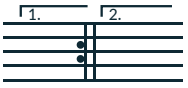
> **How to tell it worked:** while listening to “Alla Turca”, most groups give their signal in the right place and the class rebuilds the path of the piece on the board. In addition, most pupils read “Ode to Joy” with syllables and write at least one dictation correctly.

These lessons are a starting point. Each teacher can design the examples to suit their own class. For our part, we will keep adding lesson topics according to the requests we receive through the contact form.

Pupil’s sheet · The road signs

To project in class or print. Based on the slides “Clefs of the staff”, “Rhythms” and “Tempo” from *Elements of Music*.

A score is not always read from left to right and that’s it: it has signs that tell you which way to go, like the signs on a road.

It looks like this	It is called	What it says
	**Upbeat (anacrusis)**	The note (or notes) that comes before the first complete bar. It is counted from the missing beat: “Alla Turca” begins with a one-beat upbeat.
	**Repeat bars**	Whatever is between ‖: and :‖ is played twice. If there is no ‖:, go back to the beginning.
	**1st and 2nd endings**	The first time, play ending 1; on the repeat, skip to ending 2.
	**Double bar**	One section ends and another begins.
	**Final double bar**	One thin and one thick line: the piece is over.
Coda	**Coda**	Italian for “tail”: the special ending of the piece, played only once.
rit.	**ritardando**	Gradually slower and slower. Its opposite is *accelerando* (accel.): faster and faster.

Fill in:

A A B B: how many parts are heard? ____

A 1-beat upbeat in 2/4: how many beats does the last bar have? ____

Later on: D.C. (*da capo*, “from the head”: go back to the beginning) and *Fine* (“end”: where to stop after going back).

✂ cut out and take home

The path of a piece, at home

For parents · 10 minutes a week · no music knowledge needed

Today in class we reviewed how music is read and followed the score of Mozart's "Alla Turca", which has repeats and a special ending, the Coda. This week, play together:

1. **Mozart at home:** search for "Mozart Alla Turca" and listen to it together. The child raises a hand every time the cymbal march comes back.
2. **The parts of a song:** listen to a song you like and find which part comes back (the chorus). Draw it with letters: A, B, A…
3. **On the keyboard:** the child plays "Ode to Joy" (**musicmotionsuite.com/apps/mmk-demo.html**, keys C C V B · B V C X · Z Z X C · C X X).

© 2026 Music Motion